



Asia

Philippines



Wide-eyed tree-dweller

The nocturnal Philippine tarsier is one of the world's smallest primates. It lives on the southeastern islands.

A spiny exterior protects the soft fruit inside.



Marang fruit

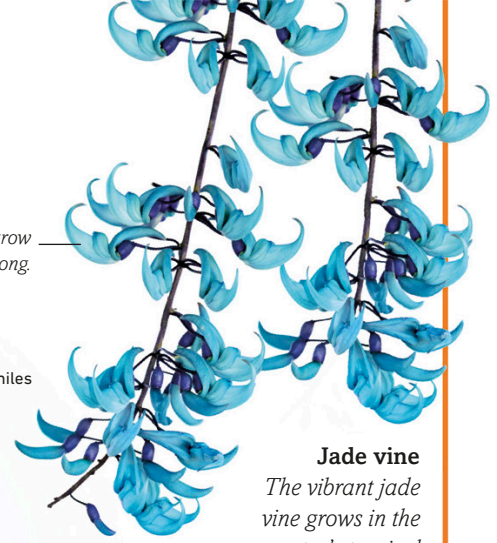
The juicy marang fruit is a local favorite. Although it does not smell very nice, the flesh is sweet.

Tinikling dance

The national dance of tinikling involves dancers moving in rhythm over a pair of bamboo poles that are slid around on the ground.



Waxy, turquoise flowers grow up to 35 in (90 cm) long.



Jade vine

The vibrant jade vine grows in the country's tropical forests, creeping up the tree trunks to reach sunlight.

PACIFIC OCEAN



Chocolate hills

The unusual conical hills of Bohol Island are covered in green grass, which turns chocolate brown in the dry season.



- 300,000 sq km (115,830 sq miles)
- 109 million
- Manila
- Filipino, English, other languages (4+)

The **Philippines** is a collection of **more than 7,000 islands** in southeastern Asia. Dotted across the country are **more than 20 active volcanoes**. The eruption of **Mount Pinatubo**, on Luzon, in 1991, was **one of the most powerful** in the 20th century.